

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

INTRODUCTION

Hospitality didn't start as a business.

It started as a responsibility.

Long before restaurants, bars, hotels, stadiums, or any structured venue existed, there was a simple expectation: if someone entered your space—physically or otherwise—you took care of them. You acknowledged them. You made them feel safe, welcome, and valued.

That wasn't branding.

That wasn't strategy.

That was the standard.

So we're going back to that.

Because you can't understand where hospitality is going until you understand where it came from—and what it was always meant to be.

In ancient civilizations, this responsibility wasn't just cultural—it was enforced.

In Babylonian times, tavern keepers who watered down beer could be put to death. Not fined. Not warned. Executed.

Extreme? Maybe.

But it makes one thing clear: the experience of the guest was taken seriously. Integrity wasn't optional. Trust wasn't negotiable. If you failed the people you served, it mattered—because the role you played mattered.

Somewhere along the way, we drifted from that.

Not all at once. Not intentionally.

But gradually. Quietly.

We replaced attentiveness with efficiency.

We replaced connection with transactions.

We replaced experience with optimization.

And in doing so, we didn't just change operations—we changed what people feel.

This isn't about one type of business.

It's not about bars, or restaurants, or hotels, or events.

It's about any environment where people show up with time, attention, and money—expecting something in return.

And right now, across all of them, there's a disconnect.

I once heard someone responsible for serving a high-volume crowd say that moments of congestion—when people are waiting, trying to get attention, unable to engage—only make up about 10% of their operational window.

From their perspective, that may be true.

But that's the problem.

Because while it may be 10% of the operation...

it's 70–90% of the guest's experience.

That moment—waiting, being overlooked, trying to engage and failing—isn't a small part of their experience.

It is the experience.